

FUNGUS KINGDOM

A poisonous toadstool in the forest is just one bit of a fungus – as is a mushroom in your kitchen cupboard! Fungi can be vast soil organisms or tiny microbes, without which many plants couldn't grow.

What are fungi?

Fungi are not plants, animals, or bacteria. They have a stringy body made up of thousands of tiny threads that spread throughout the soil.

Plant pals

Fungi can live on plant roots. They take nutrients from the soil for the plant and receive food in return.

Fungal food

Fungi have no mouths or stomachs. They absorb their food directly, or release chemicals called enzymes that break it down so it can be absorbed.

